Study Guide

In the style of OCR

To what extent do you agree that, without the use of terrorism, the Palestinians would have gained very little international support in the years to 1990?

Exam tips

The cross-references are intended to take you straight to the material that will help you to answer the question.

In this essay you need to analyse how much international support, if any, was achieved: (a) by terrorism or (b) by other means.

(a) By terrorism, you should explain the effects on international opinion of:
- Fatah's raids (although some would not class these as terrorism but as battling against the Israeli regime for an independent Palestine).
- The 'Battle of Karameh' in 1968 may not directly have won international support but certainly won more recruits for Fatah and significant international publicity (see page 80).
- More extreme methods such as hijackings and hostage-taking. Did these acts of terrorism win or lose support internationally? What was achieved by the Olympic killings? You might make use of the quotations on pages 82–3.

(b) By other means:
- The *Intifada*. Explain briefly what it was. What images of Palestinians did the world see? How, if at all, might this have gained international support? What were the effects on Israel and the USA (pages 88–9)?
- You might consider the effects on international opinion of the Israeli invasions of Lebanon and the massacres in the Palestinian refugee camps. This may not lead to any clear answer but you should, nonetheless, make an informed assessment as to whether any international support was gained (pages 84–6).

Think of any causal links you can make between the effects of terrorism in the 1970s and the *Intifada* in the 1980s. Why might the international response be more favourable in the 1980s?

You might consider whether any significant level of international support was ever achieved by any means. That would then help you, finally, to make your concluding judgement about the importance of terrorism in winning international support.